

Astha Wagle

Environment and Climate Economist

EDUCATION

DPhil in Geography and Environment 2025

University of Oxford, Smith School of Environment and Enterprise, Oxford, UK

- Research: Green Growth Strategies Towards the Net-zero Transition: Low- and Middle- Income Countries Edition

MSc Environmental Economics and Climate Change 2023

London School of Economics and Political Science, London, UK

Distinction

- Key modules: Environment & Resource Economics, Applied Quantitative Methods, Economic Appraisal and Valuation
- Thesis: Rainfall Shocks in Nepal and their Influence on Remittance Inflows: A Household-level Exploration

Postgraduate Diploma in Advanced Studies and Research (DipASR): Economics 2021

Ashoka University, Haryana, India

CGPA: 3.57/4

- Key Modules: Social Policy in India, Economics of Technology, Economics of Waste, International Finance
- Thesis: An Enquiry of the Export Trajectory of Nepal and the Role of the Readymade Garments

BA (Honours) Economics 2020

Ashoka University, Haryana, India

CGPA: 3.53/4

- Key Modules: Macroeconomics and Microeconomics Theory I & II, Intro & Advanced Econometrics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied microeconomics • Causal inference • Environmental economics • Climate policy • Green finance • Evidence-based environmental governance

RESEARCH WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Dr Aoife Brophy and Dr Mark Workman Nov '23 – Oct '25

Smith School of Environment and Enterprise, University of Oxford

UK

- Conduct scoping and targeted literature reviews across greenhouse gas removal technologies, synthesising evidence from over 100 academic papers and identifying research gaps to support 3 publications and research grant proposals.
- Model business cases and uncertainty across greenhouse gas removal technologies under alternative policy scenarios using R, supporting research on robust investment pathways.
- Work collaboratively with economists, climate scientists, engineers, and policy researchers on interdisciplinary environmental research.

Summer Student Researcher to Dr Mirabel Muules Jun '23 – Jul '23

Imperial College Business School

UK

- Contributed to an ongoing randomised controlled trial examining the adoption and use of smart plug technologies and supported research design, implementation, and data collection of experimental policy research.

Research Associate May '21 – May '22

Research Cell, Confederation of Nepalese Industries

Nepal

- Designed and analysed quarterly industrial surveys covering over 70 medium and large industries across Nepal
- Produced evidence-based reports to support industrial policy and government decision-making.

Consultant, Study team Sep '21 – Nov '21

National Reconstruction Authority

Nepal

- Evaluated the socioeconomic impacts of post-earthquake reconstruction using applied regression-based analysis and contributed to drafting and editing the final evaluation report for government stakeholders, titled Evaluation of Socio-economic Impacts of Reconstruction in Nepal.

Junior Consultant Jun '21 – July '21

International Labour Organisation

Nepal

- Analysed municipal budgets and employment programmes using regression-based methods and co-authored policy reports evaluating employment outcomes and evidence-based planning across local governments.

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- Collected required data and constructed employment friendliness scorecards for 12 municipal budgets as per matrix, and synthesised the analysis in a report.

Research Intern to Prof. Ashwini Deshpande

May '20 – Aug '20

Centre for Economic Data & Analysis, Ashoka University

India

- Performed data reshaping, cleaning, processing, and variable creation on large-scale Indian census datasets, comprising millions of data points, for the creation of the CEDA data portal using R

Research Assistant to Dr Biswo Poudel

Jun '19 – Aug '19

Nepal

- Conducted policy analysis of seven municipal budgets and public expenditure to evaluate employment generation strategies for each municipality
- Examined the federal government budget allocation for 2003-2018 to understand the employment generation pattern, plans, policies, and projects of the country

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Journal Article

Brophy, A., Calverley, J., **Wagle, A.**, Reinecke, J., & Workman, M. (2026). The strategic role of systemic transition intermediaries: A cross-sector perspective on voluntary standards for net zero. *Energy Research & Social Science*, 135, 104683.

Workman, M., Brophy, A., **Wagle, A.**, Cuthbertson, M., McCormack, L., Taricco, E., et al. (2026). Investing in Carbon Dioxide Removals: A new analytical and policy paradigm. *Energy Research & Social Science*, 135, 104669

Reports and policy publications

Lomax, C., Smith, S. M., Bellamy, R., & **Wagle, A.** (2025). The UK State of Carbon Dioxide Removal. CO2RE, Smith School of Enterprise and the Environment, University of Oxford.

Westbury, P., Arlinghaus, J., Bateman, I. J., Beerling, D., Bellamy, R., Brophy, A., et al. (2025). UKRI Strategic Priorities Fund Greenhouse Gas Removal Demonstrators (GGR-D) Programme: An Overview of Key Research Insights and Cross-cutting Findings. UKRI.

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

Co-convener | SoGE EARLY CAREER RESEARCH GROUP

Dec '23 -Present

- Provide strategic input on Early Career Research programme design and delivery as well as assist with the dissemination of the programme in Smith School, University of Oxford

Mentor | WOMEN LEAD NEPAL

Oct '20 – Present

- Empower my two mentees to achieve their goals through bi-weekly coaching sessions

Trustee | RALEIGH INTERNATIONAL TRUST UK

Jun '21 – Aug '22

- Attended monthly board meetings and ensured the smooth operation of the organisation in terms of its finance, strategy, safety, and safeguarding post-Covid 19 and co-led the Youth Advisory Group to devise a new 3-year strategy

SKILLS

Statistical analysis software: R and STATA(Proficient; 4+ years of experience), GIS and Python(Self taught:Intermediate)

Public speaking: moderated 20+ panel discussions and interviews